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The Long Afternoon

A novella

Annu

One

The house had decided, in her absence, to become smaller. Rekha noticed it the way you notice a person has cut their hair - not at once, but as a wrongness that takes a moment to name. The corridor was the same corridor. The tiles were the same cold tiles. And yet she had to turn her shoulders to pass the almirah, and she was almost certain she had never had to do that before.

Devi was in the back room with the papers. She had made two piles on the floor, and between them, like a referee, a steel thermos.

"You came," Devi said, not looking up.

End of sample

This is the opening of The Long Afternoon.

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